

GUJARAT ORIGIN

Sev Tameta Nu Shaak

Tangy Tomato Curry with Crispy Sev
A Quick Gujarati Weeknight Favorite

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Snack Food Turned Curry Topping

Sev — thin, crunchy noodles made from fried gram flour — is a snack food found across India, but Gujarat has a particular talent for weaving it into full dishes rather than treating it purely as something to nibble on the side. Sev tameta nu shaak takes this idea to its logical, delicious conclusion: a tangy, lightly spiced tomato gravy finished with a generous mound of sev stirred in right before serving, where it softens slightly at the edges while staying crunchy at the center.

The dish exemplifies the resourceful, quick-cooking spirit of everyday Gujarati home kitchens — built from pantry staples (tomatoes, basic spices, and store-bought or homemade sev) that come together in well under half an hour, making it a reliable weeknight solution when time or fresh vegetables are limited. Its appeal lies substantially in texture: the contrast between the soft, tangy gravy and the crisp sev is what makes the dish memorable rather than any complex spicing.

Sev tameta nu shaak is commonly paired with thepla or puri for breakfast or a light meal, and has become popular well beyond Gujarati households specifically because it's so simple to make and so immediately satisfying — proof that some of the best dishes come from clever, minimal-effort combinations rather than elaborate technique.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Snack Food Turned Curry Topping, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Reflects Gujarat's broader culinary talent for incorporating snack foods like sev directly into full dishes, rather than treating them purely as standalone nibbles. A quick, practical weeknight dish built from pantry staples, valued for convenience as much as flavor. Commonly served for breakfast alongside thepla or puri, though enjoyed at any meal. The textural contrast between soft gravy and crisp sev, rather than complex spicing, is the dish's defining appeal.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

10m	20m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Wooden spoon

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

The tomato curry base keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days — always add the sev fresh just before serving, as it turns soggy quickly once mixed in and doesn't hold up to storage. Reheat the curry gently, then top with sev only right before eating.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the curry

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Tomatoes, chopped	5 medium	500 g	5 medium
Oil	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Curry leaves	1 sprig	8–10 leaves	1 sprig
Green chili, slit	2	2	2
Ginger paste	1 tsp	5 g	1 chammach
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Sugar	1½ tsp	6 g	1½ chammach
Water	½ cup	120 ml	½ katori
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste

To finish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Sev (thin gram flour noodles)	1½ cups	60 g	1½ katori

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

To finish (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Sev is sold at Indian grocers, usually in the snack aisle — look for plain or "nylon sev," the thinnest variety, which works best for this dish. If unavailable, crushed plain potato chips make a surprisingly reasonable emergency substitute for the crunch, though the flavor won't be quite authentic. This dish otherwise uses only common pantry ingredients, making it very accessible worldwide.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Sev Tameta Nu Shaak

01 TEMPER THE SPICES

Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop. Add cumin seeds, asafoetida, and curry leaves, letting them sizzle for a few seconds.

02 ADD CHILI AND GINGER

Add the slit green chilies and ginger paste, cooking briefly until fragrant.

03 ADD THE TOMATOES

Add the chopped tomatoes along with turmeric and chili powder. Cook for 10–12 minutes, mashing gently with the back of your spoon, until the tomatoes break down into a thick, pulpy sauce.

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Making Sev Tameta Nu Shaak, continued



Chef tip. cooking the tomatoes down thoroughly, until they lose their raw sharpness, is essential — this is a dish about a well-developed tomato flavor, not a quick sauté.

04 ADD SUGAR AND WATER

Stir in the sugar, water, and salt, and simmer for another 5 minutes to let the flavors meld into a cohesive, tangy-sweet gravy.

Texture indicator. the gravy should be thick and glossy, coating the back of a spoon, not thin or watery.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Sev Tameta Nu Shaak, continued

05 ADD THE SEV JUST BEFORE SERVING

Right before serving, stir in the sev, mixing gently so it's evenly distributed but still retains some crunch. Serve immediately — sev softens quickly once added.



MISTAKE TO AVOID

Adding the sev too early and letting the dish sit is the most common mistake — sev turns soggy within minutes of contact with the hot gravy. Add it at the very last moment, ideally tableside.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served with thepla or puri for breakfast, a beloved quick Gujarati morning meal.
- Garnished with extra sev and fresh coriander right at the table for maximum crunch.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A quick, comforting weeknight dish alongside rice or roti, ready in well under half an hour.

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a topping for toast or as a quick, unconventional pasta-adjacent sauce for a fusion twist.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Balance Right

- Cooking the tomatoes down thoroughly before adding sugar and water builds real depth rather than a thin, raw-tasting sauce.
- The sweet-tangy balance is signature to Gujarati cooking — don't be shy with the sugar, which is meant to round out the tomatoes' acidity, not make the dish taste like dessert.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- The tomato curry base can be made a day ahead and reheated, with sev added fresh at serving time.
- This is a genuinely fast dish even from scratch, making extensive advance prep rarely necessary.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some cooks add a small pinch of garam masala at the very end for extra warmth, though the classic version relies mainly on the tempering spices alone.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

190 kcal	4 g	20 g	11 g	3 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Sev Tameta Nu Shaak with Onion	some households add a base of sautéed onion for extra body.
Sev Bhaji	a related, drier preparation with mixed vegetables and sev.
Extra Tangy Version	made with a touch of tamarind or extra lemon for those who prefer more sourness.

Can I make the curry ahead and add sev later?

Yes — this is actually the recommended approach, since sev should always be added fresh, ideally right before eating.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Where can I buy sev?

Indian grocers stock various types in the snack aisle; look for plain, thin "nylon sev" for this dish.

Is this dish very spicy?

No — it's mild and tangy-sweet rather than fiery, making it a good introduction to Gujarati flavors for those new to the cuisine.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Sev	thin, crispy noodles made from fried gram flour, the defining topping of this dish.
Shaak	Gujarati for a vegetable curry or side dish.
Tameta	Gujarati for tomato, the base ingredient of this dish's gravy.
Thepla	a spiced flatbread, a classic pairing for this dish.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Sev Tameta Nu Shaak

10m	20m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Easy
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

CURRY

Tomatoes	500 g
Oil	45 ml
Mustard seeds	4 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Curry leaves	8–10 leaves
Green chili	2
Ginger paste	5 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Sugar	6 g
Water	120 ml
Salt	6 g

TO FINISH

Sev	60 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Temper the spices.** Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop.

02 **Add chili and ginger.** Add the slit green chilies and ginger paste, cooking briefly until fragrant.

03 **Add the tomatoes.** Add the chopped tomatoes along with turmeric and chili powder.

04 **Add sugar and water.** Stir in the sugar, water, and salt, and simmer for another 5 minutes to let the flavors meld into a cohesive, tangy-sweet gravy.

05 **Add the sev just before serving.** Right before serving, stir in the sev, mixing gently so it's evenly distributed but still retains some crunch.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Tomatoes	500 g	☐ Oil	45 ml
☐ Mustard seeds	4 g	☐ Cumin seeds	4 g
☐ Asafoetida	pinch	☐ Curry leaves	8–10 leaves
☐ Green chili	2	☐ Ginger paste	5 g
☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g	☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g
☐ Sugar	6 g	☐ Salt	6 g
☐ Sev	60 g	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g

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